

Security incident report

Section 1: Identify the network protocol involved in the incident

HTTP, DNS

Section 2: Document the incident

The website has been hacked by an ex-employee by using brute force to gain access to the web host and tried several known passwords until he managed to log in and then proceeded to obtain access to the admin panel and change the website's source code. He then adds a Javascript embedded in the source code that will suggest downloading and running a file to the website's users, and after that he changes the password of the admin login. When the file is downloaded, it redirects them to a different URL, a fake version of the site that contains the malware. The incident is reported several hours later when the visitors of the site contacted the support team claiming that the site made them download a file to access free recipes and the name of the site would change which then led to their computers running noticeably slower.

Section 3: Recommend one remediation for brute force attacks

In this case, the account of the ex-employee should have been terminated; any known passwords to him should have been changed. To avoid the risk of a successful brute force attack password policies should be implemented – password should be longer, more complex, no password sharing; least privilege should be implemented, MFA could be added and there should be a limit on failed login attempts, resulting in suspended access.

